



NAVAL ARMAMENT DEPOT CIVILIAN WORKERS UNION

(Recognized by Govt. of India)

(Regd. No. 156/75 Affiliated to INDWF No. 230 INTUC No. 5156)
NAD P.O., ALUVA - 683 563, KERALA



NADCWU/8CPC/01

Date: 02 Jun 26

To

The Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief
(for Command Civilian Personal Officer)
Headquarters Southern Naval Command
Kochi – 682 004

(Through The Chief General Manager, NAD Alwaye)

Subject: Recommendations to the Eighth Pay Commission IRO Naval Civilians.

Respected Sir,

1. With reference to Headquarters Letter No. CS 2755/VIII CPC dated 25 May 2026, the NAD Civilian Workers Union (INDWF) has carefully examined the draft proposals circulated for obtaining comments and feedback from stakeholders.
2. At the outset, the Union welcomes the initiative undertaken by the Headquarters to review various cadre-related matters and service conditions of civilian employees serving under the Naval Armament Organization and associated establishments. The evolving operational environment, technological advancements, increasing complexities in work processes and changing organizational requirements necessitate periodic review of cadre structures, career progression avenues and service conditions to ensure that they remain aligned with contemporary responsibilities and functional requirements.
3. The Union has undertaken a detailed examination of the proposals contained in the aforesaid letter and has also gathered inputs from employees working in different categories and grades across the organization. Based on such examination and feedback, the Union respectfully submits the following comments, observations and recommendations for kind consideration of the competent authority.
4. The specific comments and recommendations of the Union on various subjects are submitted in the succeeding paragraphs for favourable consideration.
5. **Naval Armament Store House Staff**
 - (a) **Background**
 - (i) The Naval Armament Organization is entrusted with the critical responsibility of meeting the armament and ammunition requirements of the Indian Navy and the Indian

Coast Guard. The Organization performs a wide spectrum of functions including provisioning, procurement, production, storage in accordance with explosive safety regulations, maintenance, testing, proofing, transportation, issue and disposal of sophisticated armaments, ammunition and explosive stores.

(ii) Over the years, the Naval Armament Organization has evolved from a conventional storage and supply organization into a highly specialized engineering and technical organization. With the induction of sophisticated missiles, torpedoes, rockets, mines, guided weapons, air armaments and modern weapon systems, the complexity and technicality of operations have increased manifold. The organization today manages state-of-the-art weapon systems that directly contribute to the operational preparedness and combat effectiveness of the Indian Navy.

(iii) In this environment, the Naval Armament Store House Cadre functions as the backbone of the Naval Armament Organization. The cadre constitutes the primary workforce responsible for receipt, accounting, classification, storage, preservation, transportation, issue, inspection and inventory management of armaments, ammunition and explosives. These functions are neither routine nor comparable to ordinary warehousing activities. They demand specialized technical knowledge, strict compliance with explosive safety regulations and a high degree of professional competence.

(b) Job Roles and Responsibilities

The duties performed by Store Keeper (Armament) and Store Superintendent (Armament) include, inter alia:

(i) Receipt, accounting, storage, preservation and issue of missiles, torpedoes, rockets, mines, depth charges, detonators, fuzes, explosives and associated spares.

(ii) Inventory management of sensitive and hazardous armament stores through specialized logistics and inventory management systems.

(iii) Technical classification of armaments and ammunition as serviceable, repairable and unserviceable.

(iv) Application of United Nations Hazard Division classifications and Compatibility Group principles for safe storage and segregation of explosive stores.

(v) Determination of storage capacities, Net Explosive Content (NEC), Light Tonnage, Heavy Tonnage and safety distance requirements.

(vi) Monitoring and maintenance of explosive magazines in accordance with prescribed safety regulations.

(vii) Inspection of armament stores received from manufacturers, ports, airports and operational units.

(viii) Participation in ammunition life-cycle management, including inspection, proofing, repair coordination, life extension and disposal activities.

(ix) Handling and supervision of transportation of explosives and armaments through road, sea, jetty, barge and port operations.

(x) Operation and supervision of specialized material handling equipment, lifting gears and transportation assets employed for movement of sensitive armament stores.

(xi) Monitoring environmental conditions such as temperature, humidity, fire hazards and lightning protection systems within explosive storage areas.

(xii) Preparation and maintenance of inventory, accounting and logistics documentation through various computerized systems.

(e) The above duties demonstrate that personnel of the Naval Armament Store House Cadre are not merely storekeepers in the conventional sense but are engaged in technical, hazardous and safety-critical activities throughout their career progression. The responsibilities begin at the level of Store Keeper (Armament) itself and continue through higher supervisory grades.

(f) It is respectfully submitted that the very justification advanced for upgradation of higher grades within the Naval Armament Store House Cadre acknowledges that personnel are engaged in technical activities throughout their career and are required to handle highly dangerous explosives and ammunition. Therefore, the rationale cited for upgradation applies equally to Store Keeper (Armament) and Store Superintendent (Armament), who constitute the first line of operational responsibility and are directly involved in handling and management of armament stores.

(c) Educational Qualification Upgradation Not Reflected in Pay Structure

(i) The entry-level post of Store Keeper (Armament) has undergone significant enhancement in recruitment standards over the years. The prescribed qualification has progressively increased from 8th Standard pass to Matriculation and subsequently to Higher Secondary (10+2) with one year of experience in handling stores and inventory. However, despite these enhanced qualifications and responsibilities, the post continues to remain in Level-2 of the 7th CPC Pay Matrix, reflecting an outdated pay structure.

(ii) It is pertinent to note that Store Keeper posts in several Central Government Departments carrying similar educational qualifications and inventory management responsibilities have already been placed in Level-4. In contrast, Store Keeper (Armament) personnel handle explosives, ammunition, missiles, torpedoes, rockets, and other armament stores in accordance with statutory safety regulations, UN Hazard Classifications, Compatibility Groups, and Naval Armament safety procedures. The duties require specialized technical knowledge, strict safety compliance, and involve a high degree of responsibility.

(iii) Therefore, mere placement in Level-4 would only partially rectify the existing anomaly. Considering the enhanced recruitment standards, technical and hazardous nature of duties, and inter-departmental disparities, the entry grade of Store Keeper (Armament) merits placement in Level-5 of the Pay Matrix under the 8th Central Pay Commission. Such upgradation would be a justified recognition of the qualifications, responsibilities, and strategic role of the cadre in maintaining the operational readiness of the Naval Armament Organisation.

(d) Proposal

(i) The prescribed educational qualification for the entry grade of the cadre has progressively been enhanced over the period of time with relevant experience, reflecting the

increasing professional and technical requirements of the post. However, the corresponding pay structure has not been revised in line with these enhancements. Further, Store Keeper posts in various Government Departments are already placed in higher pay levels. In view of the enhanced qualifications, increased responsibilities and the need to maintain parity with comparable posts in Government service, the following pay structure is proposed

Designation	Existing Pay Level	Proposed Pay Level
Senior Armament Store Officer (SASO)	Level 10 (GP 5400)	Level 10 (GP 5400)
Armament Store Officer (ASO)	Level 7 (GP 4600)	Level 8 (GP 4800)
Senior Store Superintendent (Armament)	Level 6 (GP 4200)	Level 7 (GP 4600)
Store Superintendent (Armament)	Level 4 (GP 2400)	Level 6 (GP 4200)
Store Keeper (Armament)	Level 2 (GP 1900)	Level 5 (GP 2800)

(ii) We therefore earnestly request the competent authority to kindly review the recommendations and extend the proposed upgradation to Store Keeper (Armament) and Store Superintendent (Armament) in the interest of equity, administrative consistency and operational effectiveness.

6. Fire Fighting Staff

The Fire Fighting Cadre performs critical functions in safeguarding strategic assets, personnel and infrastructure of the Indian Navy. In recent years, the Recruitment Rules governing the cadre have undergone significant changes, including enhancement of entry qualifications and mandatory Fire Fighting Course qualifications, thereby increasing the professional standards and competency requirements of the cadre. However, the existing pay structure has not been revised commensurate with these enhancements. Further, the post of **Fire Engine Driver (FED)**, which is an established promotional post under the existing cadre hierarchy, has not been appropriately considered in the present proposal. In order to maintain a balanced promotional structure, recognize enhanced qualification requirements and provide due recognition to the responsibilities entrusted to Fire Fighting personnel, the following pay structure is proposed:

Sl No	Post	Present Pay Level	Proposed Pay Level
1	Deputy Divisional Fire Officer (DDFO)	Level 7 (GP 4600)	Level 11 (GP 6600)
2	Assistant Divisional Fire Officer (ADFO)	Level 6 (GP 4200)	Level 9 (GP 5400)
3	Station Officer	Level 5 (GP 2800)	Level 8 (GP 4800)
4	Sub Officer	-	Level 7 (GP 4600)
5	Leading Fireman	Level 3 (GP 2000)	Level 6 (GP 4200)
6	Fire Engine Driver	Level 3 (GP 2000)	Level 6 (GP 4200)
7	Fireman	Level 2 (GP 1900)	Level 5 (GP 2800)

It is requested that the above pay structure may kindly be considered and incorporated in the final proposal to the 8th Central Pay Commission.

7. Ministerial Cadre under DGONA

The proposal relating to the Administrative Cadre envisages merger of Administrative Officer-I and Administrative Officer-II posts and placement of the merged post in Pay Level-10 (GP 5400). Historically, the post of Assistant Armament Supply Officer (AASO) has maintained parity with Administrative Officer-II in terms of status, responsibilities and pay structure.

However, following the upgradation of Office Superintendent to Pay Level-7 pursuant to judicial intervention, the existing hierarchy has been distorted, resulting in Assistant Armament Supply Officer and Office Superintendent being placed in the same pay level despite AASO being a promotional post. In order to maintain the established hierarchy, preserve parity with corresponding administrative posts and avoid creation of a fresh anomaly, it is proposed that the post of Assistant Armament Supply Officer be upgraded to Pay Level-10 (GP 5400) and redesignated as Administrative Officer (Armament).

Category	Existing Grade Pay	Proposed Grade Pay	
Assistant Armament Supply Officer	Level 7 (GP 4600)	Level 10 (GP 5400)	To be redesignated as Administrative Officer (Armament) to maintain the parity with other services having identical nature of duties

In view of the proposed upgradation of Administrative Officer-II in the Administrative Cadre and the need to maintain parity, functional equivalence and promotional hierarchy, it is requested that the post of Assistant Armament Supply Officer may be upgraded to Pay Level-10 (GP 5400) and redesignated as Administrative Officer (Armament).

7. The above comments and recommendations are submitted after careful examination of the draft proposals and extensive consultation with the affected employees. The Union firmly believes that the proposed revisions would address long-standing anomalies, ensure parity, strengthen promotional avenues, recognize enhanced qualifications and responsibilities, and contribute towards improved morale and efficiency of the civilian workforce serving under the Indian Navy. It is, therefore, earnestly requested that the above proposals may kindly be considered favourably and incorporated in the final recommendations to ensure equity, uniformity and administrative effectiveness across all cadres.

The NAD Civilian Workers Union (INDWF) remains committed to constructive engagement and extends its sincere appreciation to the Headquarters for providing stakeholders an opportunity to offer their views and suggestions on these important matters.

Thanking you



(Tomi Joseph)
General Secretary
NAD CWU